

TV SHOW

Loki

★★★★☆ | When Loki captured the Tesseract and escaped certain death, he also escaped the ordeals of his chronological alternate, the one on the other side of the moebius strip. This is not the Loki who became a kinder version of himself. Now Loki finds himself out of time, and, facing the TVA or the Time Variance Authority, a massive fascist bureaucracy made up of time travelling cops who make sure that the universe does not collapse into chaos because of too many variations. It is now Loki's time to confront all of his actions so far and find out who he really is... and ends up finding... herself in the process? The variant that Loki has to capture and or kill... is a version of Loki from another timeline, one who is female. As the series unfolds, the audience is led to think of Loki in different genders, species and races, which is suitably



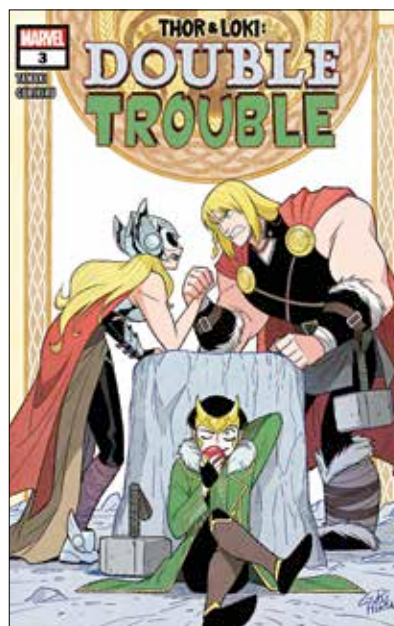
appropriate for a shapeshifter. The TVA is something like the MACUSA or MIB on steroids. The story hops and skips through multiple timelines, and manages to check the nostalgia checkbox in bizarre and interesting ways. In one sequence, Loki gets sentimental about things that never happened to him,

but that is just a mere sampling of the interesting questions that the series explores, and all of these are thoroughly satisfying. In fact, this is the hook that keeps you coming back for more, and despite giving you more and more and more Loki, you just cannot have enough Loki. Loki manages to tick the bromance and cop procedural checkboxes too, and is action packed on top of that, and the imagination of the writers do not seem to be constrained by any kind of production budgets (ahem, GOT). The canvases are epic cataclysms from history, known incidents from the MCU and planetary collisions in the future. But Loki is Loki and remains super bored through it all, which keeps the focus on Loki in every frame. This is not a post apocalyptic series, this is the apocalypse on repeat, and still the destruction outside is nothing compared to the turmoil within Loki. The series serves as the perfect antidote to superhero fatigue. If the genre is criticised for being shallow, then here you go, this is an intelligent and thought provoking series right here.

COMIC

Thor and Loki: Double Trouble

★★★★☆ | First of all it is just awesome to see Asgard rendered in the style of Gurihiru, and just seeing all these now familiar places in this style practically serves the function of canonical alt art. If you are a fan of Tartakovsky animations, or liked She-Ra on Netflix, this captures some of the same kiddish energy, with a truly universal and compelling story. This is simple enough, it is about siblings teaming up, overcoming their differences, and tackling the troubles that they face in life. The hilarious part is that the friction caused by the differences are what leads to all kinds of ridiculous troubles to begin with, and it does not help that Loki is actually at the peak of his game. If you were hyped about teenage



Groot, wait till you meet teenage Loki. This is like a blitz Loki, a superfast Loki who keeps shifting forms from a swooning girl to a horse so fast that you can blink and miss it. On top of that, the

plots and schemes are never ending and ridiculously layered... so this is just max mischief. This is a series of disasters one after the other, and yes, Odin does have to step in from time to time. The series offers an incredible window into a crucial time period between the two brothers, and has managed to capture their partnership in a very cute way, one that is suitable for very young children judging by the letters of adoration from gushing parents in the later issues. There are only four issues out, and this is a quick read, and highly recommended particularly now that the series is out, and if you feel like you can't have enough of Loki while waiting for the next episode to drop. But wait, there is more! The Double Trouble in the title has a double meaning, and one thing leads to another, with both our heroes ending up confronting alternative versions of themselves, with the genders flipped. There is no need to wait for Thor: Love and Thunder, because you can get to see female Thor in action in Double Trouble itself.